1. Under Section 1 of the Act, all British Indian territories would remain under the Company's government in India until 13 April 1854, and all property would be held by it as a trustee of the Crown;
2. Under Section 2, all privileges enjoyed by the Company would be in force only until April 1854;
3. Under Section 4, the Company was expected to expeditiously close its commercial business after 22 April 1854 and sell its properties;
4. Under Section 25, the Board of Control would thenceforth control all acts of the Company, which removed the distinction between the political and commercial activities of the company;
5. Under Section 39, a provision was made for the Governor-General of India in Council, which would have both legislative and executive powers over all of British India. William Bentinck was the first to be appointed to the position of the Governor-General of India;
6. Under Section 45, all unrepealed laws would have the same force as any legislation passed by the British Parliament, and under Section 51, the power of the British Parliament to make laws for India was spelt out;
7. Under Section 53, the creation of a Law Commission was provided for, to enquire into existing laws, work on codification of laws for common applicability with due regard to local customs and usages and taking into account 'distinction of castes, difference of religion, and the manners and opinions prevailing among different races and in different parts of the said territories'. The use of the words 'caste' and 'races' in the Charter Act has immense significance, for it reflects the entry of both categories in the administrative and legal infrastructure of the coloniser's establishment. Further, it was the first pre-Independence Law Commission of 1834 under the Chairmanship of Thomas Babington Macaulay whose recommendations led to the Indian Penal Code of 1860, the original Code of Criminal Procedure of 1898, the Indian Evidence Act of 1872 and the Indian Contract Act of 1872;
8. Under Section 87, the entry of Indians into the colonial administrative structure was facilitated through provision of a non-discrimination clause in favour of the natives. This was the precursor to the introduction of the civil services in Bharat; and